

Quality Management Plan

PeopleFirst Employee Self-Service Portal

Portfolio Project – Simulated Business Case

Document Control

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1. Purpose

The purpose of this Quality Management Plan is to define how quality will be planned, assured, controlled, measured, reported, and improved throughout the project lifecycle.

2. Quality Objectives

- **Requirements and Acceptance Quality** — Ensure project deliverables meet approved business requirements and defined acceptance criteria, with appropriate traceability from requirements through testing and acceptance.
- **Technical Quality** — Ensure the solution conforms to approved architecture, design, integration, development, and applicable non-functional requirements.
- **Testing and Defect Quality** — Ensure planned testing is completed successfully and identified defects are appropriately resolved, retested, closed, or formally accepted before progression through applicable quality gates.
- **Security Quality** — Ensure applicable security requirements are validated and material security findings are resolved or formally accepted by the appropriate authority before production deployment.
- **Release and Operational Readiness** — Ensure the solution satisfies defined testing, deployment, documentation, support, handover, and operational-readiness criteria before go-live.
- **Continuous Quality Improvement** — Monitor quality throughout delivery and use reviews, defect trends, root-cause analysis, retrospectives, corrective/preventive actions, and lessons learned to identify and implement improvements.

3. Scope of Quality Management

The Quality Management Plan applies to both the quality of the PeopleFirst Employee Self-Service Portal solution and its deliverables and the quality of the processes used to plan, develop, test, deploy, and hand over the solution.

Quality management will cover:

- **Requirements and acceptance criteria** — application of appropriate elicitation, review, clarification, validation, approval, and traceability practices, with gaps identified and managed throughout delivery.
- **Application functionality and business processes** — verification that implemented functionality and workflows meet approved requirements and acceptance criteria.
- **User interface and usability** — validation of forms, navigation, field validation, user interactions, consistency, and usability against defined requirements and acceptance criteria.
- **Solution architecture and technical design** — review against approved functional, integration, security, non-functional, and applicable technical requirements.
- **Enterprise integrations** — verification of interfaces, data exchange, connectivity, error handling, and integration behavior against approved specifications.
- **Development quality** — application of agreed development practices, code reviews, unit testing, build controls, and defect prevention/remediation practices.
- **Non-functional quality** — validation of applicable performance, availability, security, capacity, and other approved non-functional requirements.
- **Environments and test data** — readiness and suitability of development, testing, UAT/staging, and production environments and associated test data.
- **Testing and defect management** — functional, integration, regression, security, performance, and user acceptance testing, together with defect identification, prioritization, resolution, retesting, and closure.
- **Requirements traceability and acceptance** — traceability of approved requirements through design, development, testing, defect resolution, and business acceptance.
- **Documentation** — review of applicable project, technical, user, deployment, support, and operational documentation for completeness, accuracy, and readiness.
- **Release and production readiness** — verification that applicable quality gates, testing, defect, security, deployment, support, and operational-readiness conditions are satisfied before production deployment.
- **Handover and closure** — verification that required documentation, knowledge transfer, operational handover, acceptance, and closure activities are completed.

Quality will be assessed progressively throughout the project lifecycle through reviews, walkthroughs, technical verification, testing, quality metrics, acceptance activities, and quality gates. Where quality cannot be fully validated at an early stage, such as the completeness of requirements, subsequent design, development, testing, UAT, and acceptance activities will provide additional validation and identify gaps requiring clarification, correction, or change management.

4. Quality Management Approach

The project will apply a preventive, continuous, and risk-based approach to quality management, with quality activities integrated throughout the project lifecycle.

Quality will be managed through:

- **Quality Planning** – Define applicable quality standards, acceptance criteria, metrics, testing expectations, and quality gates.
- **Quality Assurance (QA)** – Use reviews, standards, peer/code reviews, walkthroughs, and process controls to prevent defects and non-conformance.
- **Quality Control (QC)** – Use inspection and testing to identify defects and verify that deliverables meet defined requirements and acceptance criteria.
- **Continuous Verification** – Validate quality progressively through requirements, design, development, testing, defect resolution, sprint reviews, and stakeholder feedback.
- **Quality Measurement and Reporting** – Monitor relevant quality metrics, test results, defects, risks, and quality-gate status.
- **Quality Gates and Improvement** – Apply defined entry/exit criteria at key stages and use defects, retrospectives, root-cause analysis, and lessons learned to drive improvement.

5. Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Quality Responsibility
Project Manager	Coordinate quality governance, ensure quality activities are planned, monitored and escalated, and confirm quality gates are incorporated into delivery.
Delivery Manager	Provide delivery oversight and support resolution/escalation of material quality concerns.
Product Owner / Business Lead	Clarify business expectations, review delivered functionality, and support acceptance/UAT decisions.
Business Analyst	Support requirements quality, acceptance criteria, traceability and clarification.
Solution Architect / Technical Lead	Define and enforce applicable architecture, design, integration and technical quality standards.
Developers	Follow coding standards, perform peer/code review, unit testing and defect remediation.
QA Lead / QA Team	Plan and execute applicable testing, manage defects, report quality status and validate exit criteria.
Security	Support security requirements, security validation and remediation of security findings.
DevOps	Support environment, build, release and deployment quality controls.
Operations	Support production-readiness, handover and operational acceptance.

6. Quality Standards and Criteria

Quality Area	Applicable Standard / Criterion	Evidence / Artifact
Requirements	Requirements are clear, feasible, testable, traceable, reviewed by relevant stakeholders, and supported by acceptance criteria where applicable.	Approved requirements / Business Analysis documentation, acceptance criteria, traceability records
Architecture / Design	Solution design supports approved functional, integration, security and non-functional requirements and is reviewed by appropriate technical stakeholders.	Solution Architecture, technical/design review records, approved technical specifications
Development	Development follows agreed coding practices; applicable work undergoes peer/code review and unit testing and satisfies the Definition of Done.	Code-review records, unit-test results, build/Jira records
Testing	Planned tests are executed against approved requirements and acceptance criteria; defects are recorded and managed; applicable entry/exit criteria are satisfied.	Test cases/results, defect records, SIT/UAT results
Security	Applicable security requirements and controls are implemented and validated; material findings are resolved or formally accepted before release.	Security requirements/specification, security review/test results, remediation/approval records
Performance / Availability	Solution meets approved performance, capacity and availability requirements defined in the NFRs.	NFR specification, performance test results
Documentation	Required project, technical, user and operational documentation is complete, current, appropriately reviewed and approved where required.	Approved/version-controlled documents and review/approval records
Deployment / Handover	Required testing, defect, security, deployment, support, documentation and operational-readiness conditions are satisfied before release/handover.	Go-live readiness checklist, deployment records, KT/handover and acceptance records

7. Quality Assurance (QA)

Quality Assurance will focus on preventing defects and improving the quality of project processes and deliverables throughout the lifecycle. The following practices will be applied as appropriate:

QA Practice	Approach
Requirements Review	Review requirements and acceptance criteria for clarity, feasibility, consistency and testability before development.
Architecture / Design Review	Review solution and technical designs against approved requirements, NFRs, integration and security expectations.
Development Standards	Apply agreed coding practices, peer/code reviews, unit-testing expectations and Definition of Done.
Quality Checkpoints	Review readiness and required quality conditions before significant testing, release and handover stages.
Process / Deliverable Reviews	Conduct walkthroughs and reviews of key project and technical deliverables as appropriate.
Continuous Improvement	Use sprint retrospectives, defect trends, root-cause findings and lessons learned to identify and implement improvements.

8. Quality Control (QC)

Quality Control will verify that project deliverables and the solution meet defined requirements, acceptance criteria, technical specifications, and applicable quality standards. The following controls will be applied as appropriate:

QC Activity	Approach
Deliverable Review	Inspect applicable project, business, technical and operational deliverables against defined requirements and review/acceptance criteria.
Unit Testing	Verify individual code components and correct identified defects before integration.
Functional & Integration Testing	Verify application functionality, business workflows, interfaces and integrated solution behaviour against approved requirements and acceptance criteria.
Regression Testing	Verify that changes and defect fixes have not adversely affected previously working functionality.
Security & Performance Validation	Test applicable security and performance requirements against approved criteria and NFRs.
User Acceptance	Validate that the solution meets business requirements and is fit for intended

QC Activity	Approach
Testing (UAT)	business use.
Defect Control	Record, classify, prioritize, resolve, retest and close identified defects according to defined defect-management criteria.
Release Readiness Verification	Verify that applicable testing, defect, security, documentation and operational-readiness criteria are satisfied before production deployment.

9. Development and Quality Lifecycle

Quality will be embedded throughout iterative delivery rather than deferred until development is complete. Each sprint will apply relevant quality activities based on the work being delivered.

Typical sprint-level flow:

Requirements Clarification → Design / Technical Clarification → Development → Code Review → Unit Testing → Build / Integration → Functional & Integration Testing → Defect Fixing & Retesting → Sprint Review / Acceptance

Backlog refinement, requirements and acceptance-criteria clarification, technical reviews, continuous testing, defect management, and Definition of Done checks will support quality throughout each sprint.

Following iterative development, the integrated solution will undergo applicable release-level validation, including SIT, security and performance validation, UAT, and production-readiness verification before go-live.

10. Definition of Done (DoD)

DoD Criterion	Required / Applicability
Requirements / acceptance criteria clarified	Required before development for applicable work items
Development completed	Required
Peer / code review completed	Required for code changes
Unit tests completed and passed	Required for applicable code changes
Applicable functional / integration tests passed	Required where applicable
Applicable security checks completed	Required where security requirements/checks

DoD Criterion**Required / Applicability**

apply

Critical / blocking defects resolved Required

Documentation / traceability updated Required where applicable

Acceptance criteria satisfied Required

11. Testing Strategy

Test Level	Primary Purpose	Owner	Entry / Exit Criteria
Unit Testing	Verify individual code components.	Development	Entry: Development completed sufficiently for unit testing. Exit: Applicable unit tests passed and identified blocking defects resolved.
SIT / Integration Testing	Verify integrated application behavior and enterprise interfaces.	QA / Technical Team	Entry: SIT environment and test data ready; integrated build deployed; planned test cases ready. Exit: Planned SIT completed; defined pass criteria achieved; no unresolved Critical/blocking defects; remaining defects assessed and accepted for progression.
Security Validation	Validate applicable security requirements and identify vulnerabilities.	Security / Technical Team	Entry: Applicable security requirements defined and testable solution available. Exit: Required validation completed; material findings resolved, mitigated, or formally accepted by appropriate authority.
Performance Testing	Validate applicable performance and capacity requirements.	QA / Technical Team	Entry: Applicable NFRs and performance criteria defined;

Test Level	Primary Purpose	Owner	Entry / Exit Criteria
			suitable environment/build available. Exit: Required tests completed and approved performance criteria satisfied, or exceptions formally assessed and accepted.
UAT	Validate business requirements and fitness for intended use.	Business / Product Owner with project support	Entry: SIT exit criteria satisfied; UAT environment/data ready; UAT scenarios available. Exit: Required UAT completed; acceptance criteria satisfied; blocking defects resolved; formal business acceptance/sign-off obtained.
Release / Production Readiness	Confirm solution, deployment, support and operational readiness.	Cross-functional team	Entry: Required testing and acceptance activities completed. Exit: Applicable testing, defect, security, deployment, documentation, support and operational-readiness criteria satisfied; go-live decision obtained.

12. Test Data and Environment Quality

Project environments and test data will be managed to support reliable development, testing, acceptance, and deployment activities.

- **Environment Readiness:** DEV, SIT/Test, UAT/Staging, and PROD environments will be configured and made available in accordance with the project schedule and applicable technical requirements.
- **Access and Connectivity:** Required user access, permissions, system connectivity, and integration endpoints will be verified before dependent activities begin.
- **Configuration Control:** Environment-specific configurations, builds, interfaces, and dependencies will be verified and controlled to reduce environment-related defects and inconsistencies.

- **Test Data:** Test data will be appropriate for the scenarios being validated. Synthetic/technical test data will be used where suitable, while client-controlled or representative data will be provided or facilitated by the client where required.
- **Environment Issues:** Environment and test-data issues affecting development or testing will be recorded, assigned, tracked, and escalated where they threaten planned activities or quality gates.
- **Production Environment:** Production access and deployment activities will follow approved release, security, and operational controls.

13. Defect Management

Defects identified during development, testing, UAT, and release validation will be recorded in the designated defect-tracking tool and managed through **logging → classification → assignment → resolution → retesting → closure**.

Defects will be prioritized based on severity, business/technical impact, and impact on applicable quality gates. Critical or significant defects requiring management attention will be escalated through the project's risk and issue management process. Deferred defects must be assessed and accepted by the appropriate authority before release.

Severity	Definition	Expected Treatment / Exit Rule
Critical	Application or critical business function is unavailable; severe security/data-integrity impact; or no viable workaround exists.	Immediate attention and escalation. Must be resolved and successfully retested before the affected quality gate/release.
High	Major functionality is significantly impaired or produces incorrect results, with substantial business impact; workaround may be limited.	High-priority resolution and retesting. Must normally be resolved before release; any exception requires documented impact assessment and formal approval.
Medium	Functionality is affected but the application/business process remains usable and an acceptable workaround exists.	Resolve according to agreed priority. May be deferred if impact is assessed, recorded, and accepted.
Low	Minor functional, usability, cosmetic, or documentation issue with little or no material business impact.	Resolve according to priority or defer to a future release/backlog with appropriate recording.

14. Requirements Traceability and Acceptance

Approved requirements will be traceable through applicable design, development, testing, defect resolution, acceptance, and release activities to provide evidence that the intended requirements have been implemented and validated.

- Each approved requirement will have a unique reference and applicable acceptance criteria.

- Requirements will be linked to relevant design/development work items and test cases where applicable.
- Test results will provide evidence of whether requirements and acceptance criteria have been satisfied.
- Defects identified against requirements will be linked to the affected requirement/test case where practical and tracked through resolution and retesting.
- Changes to approved requirements will be managed through the applicable change-control process and traceability records updated accordingly.
- UAT will validate applicable business requirements and acceptance criteria, with formal business acceptance/sign-off providing evidence of acceptance.
- Traceability will be reviewed before applicable quality gates and release to identify unimplemented, untested, failed, or otherwise unresolved requirements.

15. Quality Metrics and KPIs

Metric / KPI	Target / Threshold	Source	Reporting Frequency
Critical Defects	0 unresolved Critical defects at applicable release/quality gate	Defect Log / Jira	During testing and at quality gates
Defect Trend / Closure	Defects monitored for closure progress; no unacceptable accumulation of unresolved High/Critical defects	Defect Log / Jira	Weekly during testing
Test Pass Rate	Meet the approved pass threshold defined for the applicable test phase	Test execution results	During SIT/UAT and at exit review
Requirements / Test Traceability	All applicable approved requirements mapped to corresponding test coverage before acceptance	Requirements Traceability records	Before SIT/UAT exit and release
UAT Acceptance	Required UAT completed and formal business acceptance obtained	UAT results / Sign-off	During UAT and at UAT exit
Performance Compliance	Approved performance/NFR thresholds satisfied	Performance test results / NFR Specification	During performance validation / release readiness
Security Findings	No unresolved security findings that prevent release; residual findings formally assessed and accepted where applicable	Security assessment/test results	During security validation and release readiness

16. Quality Gates and Exit Criteria

Quality gates will be aligned with existing project milestones, phase transitions, and readiness reviews wherever practicable, rather than managed as separate governance events. Existing project and quality evidence will be used to determine whether defined exit criteria have been satisfied and whether the project may proceed to the next stage.

Quality Gate	Key Exit Criteria / Evidence
Requirements / Design Readiness	Applicable requirements and acceptance criteria reviewed and sufficiently clarified for development; required architecture/design completed and reviewed; key dependencies, assumptions, risks, and open items identified; applicable security and NFR requirements defined sufficiently for the planned work.
SIT Exit	Planned SIT completed; applicable requirements and integrations tested; defined test-exit criteria achieved; no unresolved Critical/blocking defects; remaining defects assessed and accepted for progression; test results and defect status reviewed.
UAT Exit	Planned UAT scenarios completed; applicable business requirements and acceptance criteria validated; blocking defects resolved and retested; remaining defects/issues assessed and accepted where applicable; formal business acceptance/sign-off obtained.
Production Readiness	Required testing and security/performance validation completed; release-blocking defects resolved; deployment and rollback arrangements ready; production environment/access/connectivity confirmed; required documentation, support, monitoring and operational-readiness activities completed; go-live approval obtained.
Handover / Closure	Production deployment completed and validated; agreed post-deployment issues addressed or formally transferred; required documentation and knowledge transfer completed; operational ownership/support handover accepted; outstanding actions recorded with owners; project acceptance and closure requirements completed.

17. Non-Conformance, Corrective and Preventive Action

Quality non-conformances identified through reviews, testing, audits/checks, quality gates, or stakeholder feedback will be recorded and managed through the appropriate project mechanism, such as the defect log, issue log, or action tracker.

- **Non-Conformance:** A deliverable, process, or outcome that does not meet an approved requirement, standard, acceptance criterion, or agreed quality expectation.
- **Corrective Action:** Action taken to address an identified non-conformance and, where appropriate, its underlying cause to prevent recurrence.
- **Preventive Action:** Action taken to reduce the likelihood of a potential or recurring quality problem.

- Significant or recurring non-conformances may be subject to root-cause analysis to determine appropriate corrective or preventive action.
- Actions will be assigned to appropriate owners and tracked to completion, with effectiveness verified where necessary.
- Significant unresolved quality non-conformances affecting project objectives, acceptance, or release readiness will be escalated through the established project governance process.

18. Quality Risk and Escalation

Quality-related risks and issues will be identified, assessed, monitored, and managed through the project's established risk and issue management processes.

Quality concerns will be escalated where they:

- may prevent achievement of defined quality or acceptance criteria;
- involve Critical or significant unresolved defects;
- threaten SIT, UAT, production readiness, or other applicable quality gates;
- involve significant security, performance, integration, or operational-readiness concerns;
- indicate recurring or systemic quality problems; or
- cannot be resolved within the authority or responsibility of the assigned owner/team.

The Project Manager will coordinate escalation through the established project governance and communication channels. Technical, QA, security, business, operational, or other appropriate stakeholders will assess concerns within their areas of responsibility and support resolution or acceptance decisions.

Quality risks or issues that could materially affect approved scope, schedule, cost, acceptance, or release readiness will be escalated to the appropriate decision-making authority.

19. Quality Reporting and Governance

Quality status will be monitored and communicated through existing project reporting and governance mechanisms, supported by detailed quality records maintained by the responsible teams.

Quality reporting will include, as applicable:

- testing progress and results;
- defect status, severity, trends, and significant unresolved defects;
- requirements traceability and acceptance status;
- security and performance validation status;
- quality risks, issues, non-conformances, and corrective actions;
- quality-gate/readiness status and outstanding conditions; and
- significant exceptions requiring management attention or decision.

The Project Manager will coordinate overall quality-status reporting and ensure significant quality concerns are communicated and escalated through the appropriate governance channels. QA, Technical, Security, Business, DevOps, and Operations stakeholders will provide quality information and evidence within their respective areas of responsibility.

Detailed quality information will remain in the relevant source artifacts, such as test results, defect records, traceability records, security assessments, and readiness checklists. Project status reporting will summarize material quality information rather than duplicate these records.

Quality-gate and release-readiness decisions will be supported by the applicable quality evidence and made by the appropriate accountable stakeholders in accordance with project governance.

20. Release and Production Readiness

Release and production readiness will be verified before deployment to ensure that the solution, supporting documentation, deployment arrangements, and operational support are sufficiently prepared for production use.

Readiness will include, as applicable:

- required SIT, UAT, security, performance, and other planned validation activities completed;
- release-blocking defects resolved and remaining defects appropriately assessed and accepted;
- applicable business acceptance obtained;
- production environment, configuration, access, connectivity, and integrations confirmed ready;
- deployment procedures, release package, and rollback/recovery arrangements prepared and reviewed;
- required technical, user, support, and operational documentation completed;
- monitoring, support, incident-management, and escalation arrangements confirmed;
- required knowledge-transfer and operational-readiness activities completed; and
- outstanding risks, issues, exceptions, and dependencies reviewed and accepted by the appropriate authority.

Production readiness will be assessed through the project's existing go-live/readiness review and associated quality gate. Deployment will proceed only after the applicable readiness criteria have been satisfied and the required go-live decision/approval has been obtained.

21. Continuous Improvement and Lessons Learned

Quality performance will be reviewed throughout the project to identify opportunities to improve delivery processes, prevent recurring problems, and strengthen the quality of project outcomes.

Continuous improvement will be supported through:

- sprint retrospectives and team feedback;
- analysis of defect trends and recurring quality issues;
- root-cause analysis and corrective/preventive actions where appropriate;
- feedback from testing, UAT, reviews, and stakeholder acceptance activities;
- review of quality risks, issues, exceptions, and quality-gate outcomes; and
- lessons identified during delivery, release, handover, and project closure.

Improvement actions identified during the project will be incorporated into subsequent sprints or project activities where practical and tracked through the appropriate existing mechanism.

Significant lessons learned will be captured in the project's Lessons Learned Register/Repository and reviewed during project closure for use in future projects.

22. Quality Records and Evidence

Quality records and evidence will be maintained throughout the project to demonstrate that planned quality activities, reviews, testing, acceptance, and readiness checks have been completed.

Quality records may include, as applicable:

- approved requirements and acceptance criteria;
- requirements traceability records;
- architecture, design, and technical review evidence;
- peer/code-review and unit-test records;
- test plans, test cases, execution results, and test summaries;
- defect records and retest/closure evidence;
- security and performance validation results;
- UAT results and business acceptance/sign-off;
- quality-gate and readiness review evidence;
- non-conformance, corrective/preventive action, and related resolution records;
- deployment and production-validation records;
- operational handover and knowledge-transfer evidence; and
- lessons learned and project-closure records.

Quality records will be maintained in the appropriate project repositories and tools, with suitable version control, ownership, access, and approval controls where applicable.

Existing project, technical, testing, and operational artifacts will serve as quality evidence wherever appropriate. Separate or duplicate quality records will not be created solely for the purpose of this Quality Management Plan.

Records required to demonstrate acceptance, release readiness, handover, or project closure will be retained in accordance with applicable project and organizational requirements.

23. References

- Project Charter
- Project Management Plan
- Requirements Register / Business Analysis Baseline
- High-Level Solution Architecture
- NFR Specification
- Integration Specification
- Security Specification
- Risk Management Plan / Risk Register
- Integrated Project Schedule
- Applicable organizational standards / policies

24. Approval

Role	Name	Approval / Date
Prepared By	Karthick BK	Aug 31, 2026
Reviewed By	Ananya Rao	Aug 31, 2026
Approved By	Sarah Mitchell	Aug 31, 2026